

Alyssa Soto-Gelacio, B.A.

Intermediate Team Faculty

Mary, Star of the Sea School

4469 Malia Street, Honolulu, Hawai'i 96821

Office Phone: 808-734-0208

Office Hours: 2:45–3:15 p.m. (M–F) in Room B25

Email: asoto-gelacio@starofthesea.org

ALL Teachers: 5thgradeteachers@starofthesea.org

Syllabus: 2026-2027 Grade 5 English

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Welcome to Grade 5! This syllabus is intended to help you, the student, develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me. For English, my primary focus will be to complete this year with all students developing a love for — and a grade-level understanding of — books, writing, language, and grammar.

Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLEs): Self-Aware, Confident Individuals; Teachable Life-Long Learners; Active Christians; Responsible Citizens

English Course Overview:

This course focuses on developing reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills. Students will engage with classic and modern literature, explore grammar and vocabulary, and practice various forms of writing.

Students will complete school-wide STAR Standardized Testing at the beginning, middle, and end of the school year to monitor their overall academic progress.

CLASS NOVELS:

This school year, students will read four core novels as a class, along with supplemental materials to be provided. Some are classic novels that parents might recognize; others are likely unfamiliar. The novels will be provided by the school, unless otherwise specified, at a later time. 5th-grade novels align with the different literacy lessons taught in each quarter. The 5th-grade core novels include:

- Quarter 1 — The One and Only Ivan by Katherine Applegate

- Quarter 2 — Who Was Series by numerous authors (students will be assigned a different historical person to read about)
- Quarter 3 — Tuck Everlasting by Natalie Babbitt
- Quarter 4 — A Wrinkle in Time by Madeleine L'Engle

ENGLISH GRADING POLICY:

- 35% Written Work (journals, reports, projects, etc.)
- 30% Classwork and Guided Practice
- 25% Assessments (Oral / Written Tests and Quizzes)
- 10% Participation and Collaboration

*Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic grade book via your Beehively account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance. Beehively will serve as the primary source for monitoring grades, missing assignments, and academic progress throughout the school year.

HOMEWORK POLICY:

Students are expected to read 20 minutes every day. In addition to the reading, other homework will be assigned. Your child's teachers will work together to ensure that students receive a balanced homework regimen that fosters a positive learning environment and nurtures their intellectual growth. Assignments are expected to be written daily in a student's planner and available on Google Calendar. Parents are expected to check the student's planner daily, support their child in time management, and follow through. Late work will be accepted; however, late assignments may negatively affect students' participation grades.

CLASSROOM EXPECTATIONS:

- Students are expected to come to class prepared and ready to learn.
- Homework should be completed daily and turned in. If there is a reason the homework cannot be completed on time, the teacher should be notified in advance, and a plan should be made to complete the assignment.
- Students are expected to always try their best and participate in class. They are expected to ask questions, request clarification, and communicate via office hours or email as needed.
- Students are expected to respect themselves, respect others, and respect all property.
- Class Incentives: Individual Treasure Box visit, class community rewards

Class Consequences:

- Step 1: Verbal reminder
- Step 2: One-on-one discussion, written self-reflection

- Step 3: Parent contact

REQUIRED MATERIALS:

Students should be prepared on a daily basis with the following:

- English composition book
- Core novel
- Erasable pen, pencil, eraser, and highlighter
- Glue stick / scissors
- Sticky notes
- Index cards
- Planner

Important Dates:

- Parent Orientation Night: August 12, 2026

Parent-Teacher Conferences:

- Fall: September 10–11, 2026
- Spring: February 19, 2027 (optional)

Expeditions:

- Q1 — Coconut Island: September 28, 2026
- Q2 — Pearl Harbor: November 17, 2026
- Q3 — 'Iolani Palace: March 5, 2027
- Q4 — Niu Valley Hike: June 1, 2027
- School Spelling Bee: November 20, 2026
- Christmas Performance: December 18, 2026
- End-of-Year Awards: June 3, 2027

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY:

Honesty and integrity are essential values in our classroom. Teachers have the responsibility to:

- Structure conditions during testing to alleviate the possibility of cheating
- Specify the types of collaboration that are discouraged and those that are encouraged
- Teach students the summarization of material and the distinction between summarizing and copying straight from the text

Students have the responsibility to:

- Avoid situations that might contribute to cheating or plagiarism
- Avoid unauthorized assistance
- Use sources in the prescribed manner outlined by the teacher

ABSENCES AND TARDINESS

Students may remain at home in the case of illness, accident, quarantine, or because of a death in the family.

The teacher will help the student make up for missing assignments after a short absence. When the absence is expected to be prolonged, families must notify the teacher so that a plan can be developed to complete any missing work. Repeated or prolonged absences may impede the student's academic progress and possibly the student's right to continue attending.

Students are marked tardy after the 7:45 a.m. bell rings. Explanatory notes from parents and conferences with parents may be advisable.

FOOD AND DRINK

- Food is prohibited in the classroom unless otherwise specified by the teacher.
- Sharing food is not permitted to ensure adherence to dietary restrictions.

TECHNOLOGY

- To minimize distractions and maximize learning, communication with students during the school day should be limited to emergencies.
- Student cell phones must remain off and in backpacks for the duration of a school day.
- This policy also applies to student smartwatches (e.g., Apple Watches, Gizmos, FiLiPs).

If a student is in violation of this policy, the discipline will be as follows:

- 1st Time Offense — Warning
- 2nd Time Offense — Phone will be sent to the office for student pick up from the Principal
- 3rd Time Offense — Phone will be sent to the office for student pick up from the Principal and parent will be notified

TEACHER CONTACT

- Contact me via email: asoto-gelacio@starofthesea.org
- Please allow up to 24 hours for a response on school days.
- In-person office hours: 2:45–3:15 p.m. (M–F) in Room B25

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith